

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Agents on leave in Minn. killing

White House faces escalating backlash over nurse's death

By Reis Thebault, Nicholas Bogel-Burroughs and Chris Cameron
The New York Times

The two federal agents who opened fire on a Veterans Affairs nurse in Minneapolis have been on leave since the shooting, an official with the Department of Homeland Security said for the first time Wednesday.

It was unclear if the department had taken action regarding the other agents involved in the encounter with the nurse, Alex Pretti, including those who had helped restrain him before he was shot and killed by the two agents.

Trump administration officials, who stridently defended the killing and falsely described the actions of Pretti, 37, before he was killed, have not publicly identified the agents who shot him.

On Sunday, Gregory Bovino, who was then overseeing President Donald Trump's Border Patrol operations in the city, told CNN that the agents involved in Pretti's shooting were still working, had been moved to other cities and were "more than likely be on administrative duty."

Stephen Miller, a top aide to Trump, has suggested that federal agents "may not have been following" protocol before the fatal shooting of Pretti, after days in which Miller and other Trump administration officials portrayed the shooting as justified.

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Congressional candidate Katherine "Kat" Abughazaleh, center, and her deputy campaign manager Andre Martin, far left, leave the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago's Loop with their attorneys on Wednesday. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'Broadview Six' want evidence made public

Protesters' attorneys say Minneapolis killings reveal need for transparency

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Defense attorneys in the politically charged "Broadview Six" case accusing a group of Democrats and other protesters of conspiring to impede immigration agents argued in a court hearing Wednesday that recent events in Minneapolis have augmented the need to keep evidence in the case public.

The comments came during a

hearing before U.S. District Judge April Perry on a flurry of defense motions, including requests to limit a protective order on discovery materials and order the Department of Homeland Security to preserve surveillance footage in the days before and after the Sept. 26 incident.

Defense attorney Terrence Campbell told the judge the protective order suggested by prosecutors, which would keep

portions of exchanged evidence "for attorneys eyes only," was too restrictive and "creates all sorts of problems" in a case of such public importance.

"You don't have to look any farther than the last 2½ weeks of news to know it is very relevant to the public how federal law enforcement officers from ICE and Homeland Security are behaving and interacting, and whether they are instigating," Campbell said,

a reference to the killings of two U.S. citizens by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents in Minnesota. "We can't leave our common sense at the door."

Assistant U.S. Attorney Sheri Mecklenburg said it was the defense that was politicizing the case, noting some of the defendants were using it in their campaigns for elected office.

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'Pathway' to prosecute Bovino

Mayor Brandon Johnson tells a Washington crowd he would prepare Chicago for the future prosecution of Border Patrol's Greg Bovino. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

Dems tie demands to shutdown

As a partial government shutdown looms at the week's end, Senate Democrats have laid out a list of reforms for ICE, other agencies. **Nation & World in Business, Page 5**

Pressure mounts against Noem

Calls mount for ouster of Homeland Security secretary after killings of two Minnesotans who were defending immigrants. **Nation & World in Business, Page 5**



Horses on the track on April 6, 2024, at Hawthorne Race Course in Stickney. VINCENT ALBAN/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hawthorne eyes new casino deal

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

Hawthorne Race Course officials Wednesday said again they were close to a financing deal for a new casino, despite a recent financial crisis that has led to bounced checks and suspension of its harness racing license.

Assistant General Manager John Walsh told the Illinois Racing Board that Hawthorne

President and General Manager Tim Carey was in Chicago working on the deal, though the track has had six years of failed promises to open a combination race-track and casino, or "racino."

"We're working with a new partner," Walsh said. "Someone who's nearby and has been trusted in Illinois and in racing ... (who) wants to move quickly. It's not going to be the same old, same old. We're actually work-

ing on something that's going to happen."

His announcement came after the board suspended the harness racing license at Hawthorne due to its financial difficulties. The board had canceled racing at the track Jan. 3 and 4 because of its failure to get required surety bonds. Since then, the track has canceled all its races this year.

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Lurie planning new children's hospital in Downers Grove area

By Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

Lurie Children's Hospital is in the early stages of planning a new children's hospital in the Downers Grove area, Lurie announced Wednesday.

The new hospital would be the system's first hospital with inpatient beds outside of its main facility in Streeterville. The plan follows years of closures of pediatric units at community hospitals across Illinois.

The new hospital would likely have about 40 to 50 inpatient beds, an emergency department with about 40 rooms, surgery suites and offer subspecialties such as oncology, cardiology, gastroenterology and

orthopedics, said Dr. Tom Shanley, Lurie president and CEO.

The facility would be low-acuity, meaning that it would be intended for children who don't necessarily need the highest, most complex level of care, which is provided at Lurie's downtown hospital. For example, children who are hospitalized for respiratory illnesses sometimes need little more than extra oxygen, which is a service that can be provided at a lower-acuity hospital, Shanley said.

"It affords us an opportunity to develop inpatient beds and keep children closer to home for the care that they need," Shanley

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CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE

CHICAGO SPORTS

Waving a White flag?

Barely a week away from the NBA trade deadline, Coby White is the centerpiece of the Bulls' offerings. In his seventh season, White has become an awkward fit in a rapidly lengthening timeline for the Bulls' youth movement.